

BARBARA MCGRATH

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Profile

16 years in QA/Testing, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: pytest and CI/CD.

Selected Highlights

- » Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- » Owned release sign-off for 4 services, coordinating across product and support.
- » Reduced escaped defects by 55% through risk-based test prioritisation.

Work Experience

Senior Test Automation Engineer, Nova Tech Group

Oct '19 – Present | Donnatown

- » Mentored 40 manual testers into automation roles.
- » Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Cypress, catching defects staging had missed.
- » Drove accessibility coverage from 30% to 85% of core journeys.
- » Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.

Quality Engineer, Lumen Works

Aug '14 – Oct '19 | Natalieberg

- » Established test data management practices later adopted by 12 teams.
- » Built a performance harness in Cypress simulating 20k concurrent users.
- » Integrated automated checks into the Datadog pipeline, blocking 50 faulty releases.

Quality Engineer, Ironwood Consulting

Sep '12 – May '14 | Lopezton (Hybrid - 2 days on-site)

- » Automated 2 regression suites with Cypress, cutting the manual test cycle by 40%.
- » Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.

Test Automation Engineer, Clearwater Systems

Jul '11 – Sep '12 | East Davidmouth (On-site)

- » Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 6% to 85%.
- » Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 10 hours to 8 minutes through parallelisation.

Fenwick Digital — Quality Engineer

Jan '10 – Jun '11 | Port Elizabeth

- » Led a team of 3 through a full replatforming with no missed delivery dates.
- » Interviewed and onboarded 2 new hires, shaping the hiring bar for the team.

Academic History

Master, Computer Science

West Amanda State University | 2008

Thesis: “Scheduling strategies for distributed task queues”

Bachelor, Mathematics

Port Wendybury Institute of Technology | 2003 – 2006

Core Competencies

pytest | CI/CD | Cypress | Jira | Java | Python | GitHub Actions | JavaScript | Docker | Git | TypeScript | React | Linux | BigQuery | MongoDB | Datadog